

STATE OF NEW YORK

8216--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN ASSEMBLY

May 5, 2025

Introduced by M. of A. WRIGHT -- read once and referred to the Committee on Aging -- recommitted to the Committee on Aging in accordance with Assembly Rule 3, sec. 2 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the elder law, in relation to establishing the senior center council; and to repeal certain provisions of such law, relating thereto

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Section 216 of the elder law is REPEALED and a new section
2 216 is added to read as follows:

3 § 216. Senior center council. 1. Definition. For the purposes of this
4 section, the term "council" shall mean the senior center council
5 convened by the director pursuant to this section.

6 2. Membership. The senior center council is hereby established. The
7 senior center council shall consist of ten members appointed by the
8 director, who shall serve as the chair. These members shall have experi-
9 ence with the operation of senior centers and the provision of services
10 therein. Members shall also be broadly representative of older adult
11 groups and all geographic areas of the state. At least two of these
12 members shall be over the age of sixty-two. The council shall convene
13 within one hundred eighty days after the effective date of this section
14 and annually thereafter.

15 3. Compensation. Members of the council, other than the director,
16 shall receive no compensation for their services, but shall be allowed
17 their actual and necessary expenses incurred in the performance of their
18 duties pursuant to this section.

19 4. Purpose. The purpose of the council shall be to (a) provide a forum
20 for discussion of challenges facing senior centers across the state and
21 developing solutions;

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 (b) support sharing of information regarding efficient and effective
2 operation of senior centers in different areas around the state;

3 (c) encourage the spread of methods and programs with proven effec-
4 tiveness;

5 (d) create an environment for peer-to-peer support for senior centers
6 across the state;

7 (e) offer recommendations for how the state can support senior centers
8 and lower barriers to effective service delivery; and

9 (f) offer recommendations on existing services and cost effective
10 measures to ensure the long-term sustainability and viability of senior
11 centers in all areas of the state.

12 § 2. This act shall take effect immediately.